



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

VOL. 10 ISSUE
Sept 2023

#9

COMING EVENTS

SEPTEMBER

2nd Cent Coast Workshop
4-8th Painted Silos Tour
7th Monthly Meeting-ZOOM
13th Committee Meeting
16th Mid Nth Coast W'shop
17th All British Day
20th Long Lunch at Taralga
23rd Central West Workshop

OCTOBER

5th Monthly Meeting
7th Central Coast Workshop
8th Make-a-Wish
11th Committee Meeting
28th Estate Lunch

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Not the Maude Project Snippet

By Ian Richter



Dear Reader

I have a confession to make. I have done absolutely nothing on Maude the BN1 project this month. Do I feel good about this? No, not at all. Before you turn away in despair please let me regale you with a tale.

It had been a while, 12 months almost to the day, since I had driven our BJ7. We drove along the Hamilton Highway in regional Victoria. I had not forgotten the feel of the seat cushion, the steering wheel or even how harsh the suspension of "BEATIE" was. Her

new engine ticked along beautifully, and the exhaust sounded quieter than before, yet still retained its raw qualities. Travelling from Melbourne, we are well over half-way to our destination with only 120 kilometres remaining. The Austin-Healey needs fuel, and we pull into the Derrinallum township service station. The attendee behind the counter eagerly asks, What is it? What year model? and Did you restore it? The usual general questions of interest. During the past year, I have missed these conversations. I smile and reply, but have no time for an extended chat.



Design by Amy Q Design



cont' on P8



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Our monthly meetings are held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the bistro from 5.30pm.

The opinions and advice expressed in the Flat Chat Newsletter are not necessarily those of the editor or the Austin-Healey Owners Club (NSW) Inc. For technical advice it is suggested you seek professional support.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

It's 10.00pm Sunday evening, and Patrick needs my report today and I haven't even started to think about what to report. Normally by this time it is finished and submitted or at least being tarted up to look presentable; but Father's Day was good and hopefully all the other dads had a great day.

The past month has been a little busy and it is almost unbelievable that winter has now gone and spring has sprung. Time certainly passes more quickly these days, which my brother theorises is caused by the earth now spinning more quickly and accelerating the time that the sun does its orbit. Maybe he has something there.

As some of you know I have been in Flowerpot, Tasmania for the last month helping to care for my father-in-law, so have been out of the loop so to speak. Today I received the latest copy of the *Australian Austin-Healey* magazine with the rest of my mail which had been redirected during my absence



and I have only had a chance to flick through the pages and look at the pictures but there's always tomorrow. I also need to get my act together.

This month's general meeting will be via Zoom. The reason for the change, just for this month, is that many of our regular attendees will be absent either overseas or on the Painted Silos Tour. If you're available on Thursday evening you will be made most welcome to join in. Details were sent last week, and you will find them again in this newsletter. I'm looking forward to hearing of the adventures of the intrepid travellers.

As mentioned earlier, time is flying, and we are approaching when we need to hold our AGM. This year it will be 2nd November, so now is the time to start thinking about, and discussing with other members whom you believe can take an active role in the running of our club. For many of the positions, there is a bit of a position description on the committee page of our website. So you wish to know more about what's involved you can find it there or I'm happy to discuss this with anyone who wishes more information.

Time to get the Austin-Healey out in the warmer weather.

COMMITTEE LIST - 2023

Club Patron—Ross Bond

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jpjimbeau@gmail.com

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Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's postal address at left

Public Relations - Ross Penman
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Non-Committee Positions
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ronnie Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Greg Strange

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Stirtion
0414 472 877
Geoff Smith
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read, Alan Jones (D),
Warwick Sell (D), Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick
Quinn, Terry Bancroft (D), Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the
Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn
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Greetings and welcome to the September 2023 issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter and I trust there are a few words within of interest.

It's Spring, a time when a young person's fancy turns to thoughts of their Austin-Healey. Well I don't know if the word 'young' continues to be relevant, but the thoughts are certainly turning towards the Quinn Austin-Healey. More about what's happening later.

Lots of thanks to members who have taken the trouble to send in their words and photos.

If you have got this far you have probably already read Ian Richter's reunion story with Richter 3000. Thanks Ian for the words and the photos. Thanks as well to Allan Whitehouse for the story on fitting new brake pads to his BJ7. Knowing Allan it comes as no surprise that it wasn't a simple out and in exercise. So I'm pleased to say that he has given us chapter and verse as to what was involved. Thanks also to Graham Healey and Colin Rule for sending in a couple of interesting receipts, around each is an interesting histories.

Also thanks to all involved for preparing reports on the various AHOC events held over August. All make for enjoyable reading and hopefully will entice other members to join events into the future. Oh yes! Exciting stuff there is also a set of minutes to enjoy.

Once again the Quinn Austin-Healey was driven up on to a flat bed and taken across town. This

time it was to Artarmon, where it is as I write this. It's at the Cessario beauty shop, otherwise known as Platinum Smash Repairs. You might recall there was some damage caused to the front shroud when we were fitting the quart size six-cylinder engine through the pint size opening of the 100 shroud. I won't go into how I tried to prevent it all with my right hand resulting in red slippery stuff everywhere. Anyway that repaired itself without an insurance claim, unlike the shroud.

I trust you enjoy this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter. Please do send me some words and photos of what you have been up to.



Vince Cessario coming to grips with the Quinn Austin-Healey

Vale Greg Tucker

It is with sadness that I convey the news of the passing of Bathurst based member Greg Tucker on August 30th. It is understood that he has been in poor health for some time. Greg joined the AHOC in April 2018 with a BJ8 and living where he did, we didn't have the pleasure of meeting him.

It is sad when a fellow member passes, even when they are not well known to you. We are all part of a community and to lose someone from that community makes you sit back and contemplate what has happened.

Our condolences to Greg's partner Sandy Matiszik.



Greg Tucker enjoying his BJ8 at Mt Panorama

Monthly Meetings - Zoom ID 980 9019 7648 Passcode 336164

Normally we meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm



Minutes of the General Meeting

Thursday, 3 August 2023

Meeting commenced at 7:35pm.

Venue - Strathfield Golf Club

ATTENDEES

As well as members present at the Golf Club, three attended by Zoom.

VISITORS & NEW MEMBERS

N/A

APOLOGIES

Mal French, Garry & Julie Lee, Ross & Jenny Penman, Geoff Smith

MINUTES

Minutes from the previous month's meeting on 6 July were passed as a correct record. This is despite the fact that they hadn't been included in Flat Chat as they weren't available!

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Jim, who'd joined online from Tasmania, spoke about the huge turnout at Terry Bancroft's funeral, and the stories that came out in the eulogies. There was a link in Flat Chat to the live stream of the funeral, for those that were unable to attend.

He also thanked Kathleen Long for providing tickets for a couple of Club members to attend the Repco Supercars race.

At the previous month's Committee meeting, it had been agreed to introduce multi-year memberships. It was hoped that this would mean less admin for everyone.

Jim said he was also going to be reviewing the constitution, so if anyone had any ideas, could they let him know.

Lastly, he advised of a Club Business Workshop being run by Motorsport Australia on 21 August, on the topic of club insurance, so if anyone had any insurance-related questions, could they let him know.

VICE-PRESIDENT'S REPORT

No report.

SECRETARY'S REPORT

No report.

TREASURER'S REPORT

In Jenny's absence, Jim reported on the Club's bank account balances, and income and expenditure.

TREASURY REPORT FOR AS AT 31 JULY 2023		
Main Account 632-648 252564 \$32,421.18	Debit Card 632-648 248888 \$303.82	Term Deposit 635-152 911243 \$70,000.00
Cash Reserve Account 632-648 252572 \$22,103.68	Charles Run Account 632-648 277411 \$1,844.13	Total Members Funds \$124,828.68
Income		\$3,275.72
Membership Fees		\$2,500
Regalia		\$648
Interest		\$29
Expenses		\$948.60
Membership		\$100
Flowers		\$140
Donald Healey Celebration		\$708

MEMBERSHIP

Christine advised that 34 members from the previous year still hadn't paid, despite having been sent a reminder.

Also, Bryan Bavistock had applied to join the Club, so this would go to the next Committee meeting for approval.

SOCIAL SECRETARIES' REPORT

Bruce ran through the upcoming social calendar:

All British Day

Sunday, 17 September 2023

9:00am - 3:30pm

Kings School North Parramatta

Saturday 5th August
Central Coast Technical Workshop & Sydney Technical Workshop "On T

Wednesday 9th August
JindyAndy Grain Mill 719 Greenwell Point Rd, Pyree

Saturday 19th August
Mid North Coast Technical Workshop 79 Barton St Croke

Sunday 20th August
Central West Chapter - Bathurst Historic Car Club 34th Annual Swap M

Sunday 27th August
Spring Cherry Blossom Festival Auburn - Auburn Botanical Gardens

Bruce acknowledged that as members got used to the regular chapter timetables, most events were attracting good attendance, which was really pleasing.

So far, over 30 people had confirmed for the Painted Silos Tour. Anyone that was still thinking about it needed to get their skates on, as accommodation was filling up.

Chris Hatch, who was online, gave an update on what was coming up for the Mid-North Coast chapter. Off the back of his multimeter talk and subsequent article in Flat Chat, Chris said he was going to put together a cheat sheet for members.

WEBMASTER'S REPORT

No report.

WELFARE OFFICER'S REPORT

Cards sent by Pamela on the Club's behalf included a condolence card to Vicki Mitchell (for her brother) and get-well cards to Dot Menzies, Liz Goodare and Wayne Watkins. Christine had also organised a condolence card for Doug and Pamela following the passing of Doug's sister.

Patrick advised of a former member, Bob Smith, who had sadly passed away the previous day.

EDITOR'S REPORT

Flat Chat had been sent out the previous evening and the Australian Austin-Healey was due to go out the following Tuesday.

REGISTRAR



Historic Vehicle Registration News

Patrick advised there were now 230 cars in the Club on Conditional Registration, with 72 of these being marque cars. He also referred to the list he'd put in Flat Chat of the various models in the Club. Although overall numbers hadn't changed much, there'd been some coming and going of cars, both interstate and overseas.

HISTORIAN

Joe regaled the meeting with some stories out of his vast store, including about how towards the end of Healey production, BMC ran a competition to see what ideas might come out of it. The winning design ended up being the Pininfarina Healey. Patrick later noted that this car had featured in Issue 20 of the AAH.

LIBRARIAN

Nothing to report.

TECHNICAL OFFICER/CLUB EQUIPMENT/ SPARE PARTS

Greg talked about the recent workshop he'd hosted where the guest speaker had worked at BMC for many years. Attendees were really interested in hearing about his experience.

PUBLIC RELATIONS REPORT

No report.

CMC REPORT

Greg said at the recent CMC meeting the topic of seatbelts had come up again. Although older seatbelts fitted were OK, it appeared that seatbelts being fitted in newer restorations required certification. There was also discussion on the wording of RTA rules. To be considered a club run, it needed to be in a club's minutes or club diary, but it was at the discretion of the officer at the time as to the evidence required. Bruce noted that he was in the process of updating Club events on the website, which would provide evidence if needed.

ASSOCIATION OF BRITISH CAR CLUBS

There was brief discussion on the All British Day.

CSCA REPORT

Colin talked about how he still hadn't recovered from the long, long walk he'd had from the car park while attending the Repco Supercars, but he still had a fantastic time, and was impressed with the S5000 cars. He was not so impressed at getting out of the car park – having started up the car at 9:20pm, by 10:05pm he still hadn't moved! He thought there might still be cars stuck there.

Colin also provided a very handy tip for stopping the choke going back in of its own volition.

The Lotus Car Club, which was running the Super Sprint on 19 August, was looking for volunteers to help out on the day.

REGALIA

Colin spruiked his regalia items and successfully parted some members from their cash!



SHOW & TELL

Alan Mitchell and Ray Roberts in particular delivered some entertaining Show and Tells. You had to be there.

GENERAL BUSINESS

Joe Armour acknowledged some of the older more long-standing members of the Club who'd attended Terry Bancroft's funeral.

Bruce Ewan checked who was coming to All British Day.

Colin Rule mentioned that his plan to have lunch at Patonga for the next Central Coast workshop was a bit tricky, as Patonga got awfully busy, and parking was difficult. It was agreed to change it to having a sausage sizzle at the Rules' instead.

Austin-Healey Windcreens



OR



FOR SALE

Austin-Healey windcreens. 100, 100/6, MK1, MK2, BJ7 and BJ8. \$265.00 ea. Limited stock.

Contact Colin Rule on (02) 4368 2938 or 0467 563 523.



Social Report

Bruce Ewan 0432 096 493
Bruce.ewan1@gmail.com

Denis Kasza 0407 492 008
deniskasza@gmail.com

August was a comparatively quiet month compared to the National Rally in July. However, members had plenty of opportunities to get out and enjoy their cars while participating in fun activities with like-minded companions. The chapters were again very active, and the Sydney area had an excursion. Central West's activity unfortunately couldn't proceed due to lack of support, but Central Coast, Illawarra/Southern Highlands and Mid-North Coast Chapters all proceeded as planned. All reports can be read elsewhere in this month's Flat Chat Newsletter.

This month sees some exciting events for members to enjoy, including chapter activities, the Painted Silos Tour and the All British Day.

FUTURE EVENTS

MID NORTH COAST CHAPTER

Saturday 16th September (3rd Saturday Each Month):
 Technical Workshop & Meet
 Address: 79 Barton St Croki
 9am to 12pm (Please let Phil Lorking you're coming)
 Phil Lorking 0412 392 3620 thelorkings@outlook.com.au or Denis Kasza 0407 492 008
 Please bring a contribution to morning tea

ALL BRITISH DAY

Sunday 17th September
 Address: Kings School Parramatta
 8.30am to 3pm

Last held in 2019, the All British Day will be held again on 17th September 2023. Wonderful to see that this event is finally back on the calendar, as the many British marques on show will make for an enjoyable and interesting day out, as well as the possibility of viewing period fashions on display. Over the last three years, there have been many new Austin-Healeys added to the club register and likewise many that have been upgraded, revitalised, painted and more.

Display cars to enter via Masons Drive, North Parramatta. Gates open at 7.30am, last entry 9.30am. Visitors after 8.30am.

Have a look at –

<https://www.austinhealeynsw.com.au/events/view.php?id=I5ZX0P1D9W7YC6H8QJ6QUZD-Q9LOV75T7HU3LZVGKY5DH9A4CI9ONE23X-W5LCZMP4>

AHOC of NSW has a small number of pre-purchased tickets. Contact Bruce Ewan 0432 096 493

AHOC ILLAWARRA & SOUTHERN HIGHLANDS CHAPTERS

“Long Lunch” Taralga

20th September

See page 16 for details

CENTRAL WEST CHAPTER

Saturday 23rd September: Technical Workshop & Meet

Address: 8 P J Moodie Memorial Drive, Raglan NSW 2795 (near Bathurst Airport). 9.30 am to 12pm
 Greg Poole 0403 839 482 or Bruce Ewan 0432 096 493

Please let Greg or Bruce in advance if you wish to attend and bring a contribution to morning tea.

CENTRAL COAST CHAPTER

Saturday 7th October (1st Saturday Each Month):
 Technical Workshop & Meet
 Address: 109 Humphreys Road South Kincumber
 9:15 AM – 12:00 PM
 (NO NEED TO REGISTER)
 Please bring a contribution to morning tea

OCTOBER LUNCH

COOLANGATTA ESTATE VINEYARD, SHOALHAVEN HEADS

Date: Saturday 28th October

Address: 1335 Bolong Rd, Coolangatta NSW
 10am to 3pm

Activities: Lunch 12.30pm at Coolangatta Estate, with optional 45-minute wine-tasting \$15 pp
 For members coming from the north, meet at Heathcote Maccas 10am, depart 10.30am. Approximately 1 hour 20 minute drive to optional visit to The Treat Factory, Berry, prior to lunch. Coolangatta Estate is 15 minute drive from Berry

Please RSVP on the club website or to the above-mentioned contacts, as Coolangatta Estate will need booking numbers. (See page 19 for more detail)

Cont' from Page 1

Our escapade started later in the day than planned, and I had concerns about the weather. The destination is Port Fairy, deep along the Victorian coast. The sky was very grey, and rain was forecast. I did not want to be caught needing to rely on windscreen wipers whose efficiency was not part of the design brief and whose slow single-speed covered all rain variations. The rain eventually arrived about twenty kilometres out from Port Fairy. We were now travelling along the Hopkins Highway when the heavy pelting of water surprised both us and the wipers. I slowed down for the wipers to catch up, and as usual, when it rains, water streams in around the car's hardtop to be absorbed by the occupants inside. One small cloth between us is used to plug the leaks and defog the windscreen. I have no complaints. What a joy it is to drive our 3000 again, even in foul weather. Jennifer and I have been grinning like loons most of the drive.



tech race to historic motors. The keen-eyed reader of the Australian Austin Healey magazine would recognise that PowerPlay is often referenced in articles, particularly regarding motorsport Austin-Healeys.

After speaking with Simon and without hesitation, BEATIE was loaded on the back of a truck one rainy afternoon and sent down to Cheltenham for its twelve-month stay. You may be thinking one year is a long time for an engine build, and it is. I will put some perspective around the time. Firstly, I was not in a rush. It was a complete engine rebuild, including a replacement block. The attention to detail that Simon puts into the engine builds is next level. He would call and discuss all decisions and suggestions at every primary stage of the machining and assembly process, keeping me well informed. PowerPlay, being a small business of two and having a demanding customer base largely around the preparation of cars for race/rally events, their priorities needed to be juggled and things take time. I understood that! Additionally, there were other pieces of work required on our car, brakes, rear axle, some engine bay bodywork, and improvements on the suspension, which I had planned to complete in the future. Get it all done, I say. Simon was happy to take the additional work and put in the same level of quality and engineering required to complete it.



A little over twelve months ago, I picked up an engine tick in our Austin-Healey. Having had the engine rebuilt a few years previously, I wasn't expecting to have any engine trouble. As I drained the oil and found metal swarth, it was all bad news from there. Disappointment didn't even scratch the surface of how I felt about the engine failure, and the time and cost of the previous engine work.. lost. I was recommended to give Simon Gardiner of PowerPlay a call. PowerPlay are engine specialists, based in Cheltenham, Victoria, run by two gents, Simon Gardiner and Mike Conway. Their business covers the full gamut of car preparation, development and rebuilds, and Simon's specialty is engines from high-

From receiving the call from Simon to say BEATIE is good to go, took a couple of weeks to create enough space in our activities to tear down to Melbourne and drive the 3000 back home on the NSW Central Coast. Simon suggested it would be best to get some miles (800 Km) on the engine than leave it with him for a day for a review and a tweak before

cont' from prev page

we ventured north. We had no set plan on where to stay except it needed to be far enough from Melbourne and return to get the required kilometres but also enable us to just relax in an interesting location for a few days without having to rush about.

About 300 kilometres west of Melbourne is the charming coastal village of Port Fairy. It is alive with history, nature and wonderful food choices. Our three-night stay was at the fabulous Drift House, a small boutique hotel with six nicely refined suites that mix the old charm of its buildings and modern architecture. Our stay went far too quickly and at 7 a.m. Monday morning, we found ourselves pushing the Austin-Healey out the drive onto the road before I started the engine. This was my veiled attempt to be considerate to the other guests. Without any choke or fuel enrichment, the triple Webers cough and carry on until the engine catches. Simon made it quite clear to warm the engine, "Hold it at 1,500 rpm to reduce the wear on the cam," he said, "Once warm, you are good to go". In a town where silence and tranquillity are selling points, starting the 3000 early morning was slightly uncomfortable. Nevertheless, the new exhaust does sound the business.

It has been a while since we travelled in regional Victoria and it was definitely worth the visit. The roads are lightly travelled, and the scenery and towns passed by are both interesting and picturesque. The drive back to PowerPlay was three hours and forty minutes from Port Fairy. After a few stops and some touristy things, we had the Austin-Healey back to Simon so he could run his checks. Jennifer and I

planned to spend a couple of days in Melbourne and when BEATIE was checked and Simon was happy we would wander home across a few days.

The drive back from Melbourne to our home along the Hume Highway is long but easy, and we broke it up stopping off and staying in a few places on the way, we were in no rush. On our little trip of seven days, we travelled about 1,900 kilometres. The car performed flawlessly, as was expected.

I will get back on track with the Maude project, but the novelty of having BEATIE back in the shed has not yet worn off. At every opportunity, I find myself driving aimlessly just to listen to the engine and feel the performance that Simon engineered into the Austin-Healey motor. It's intoxicating!



The September meeting is scheduled for 7.30pm Thursday the 7th and will be held on Zoom. ID 980 9019 7648 Passcode 336164

Chapter News

Central Coast - 5 August



Kathleen Long talking about the history of Repco.

Once again the weather was with us although overcast. The rain held off to see another very successful Saturday morning Central Coast Workshop.

We had a record number of 30 enthusiasts for one of the special meets of the year with invitations to the Sydney Workshop, Newcastle and the surrounding districts.

A very special welcome to our guest speaker from Repco, Austin-Healey owner and member Kathleen Long. Kathleen gave an extremely informative 40 minute talk and history lesson on the Repco Company. She talked about its inception in 1920, to the present day and the acquisition of a multitude of companies along the way.

We were all fortunate enough to receive a Repco cap, cup holders and can openers, just for turning up. The whole 30 of us!

A special welcome to the newbees. Victor and grandson Eli Sullivan our next-door neighbours. From Sydney, Scott Graham and Mike Thomas, John Hall E-type, Graham Nasmith, Neville Stirton and Damien Carrick BJ8 and of course Kathleen Long.



Central Coast Cont

From the Hunter region we welcomed George Greig and Bruce Corke. While our regular attendees were Julie and Garry Lee BJ8, Richard Horwood, Louise Gabriel, Jenny and Ian Richter BJ7, Roger Ramsay, Doug and Pamela Ross BJ7, Larry and Helen Johns BN2, Mark McAllan BJ8, Lew McAllan MK1 BN7, John Wakeling 240Z, Richard Cardew Sunbeam Alpine, Denis Kasza and Susie Doctor Westminster, Col and Kerrie Rule BN2.

Coffee, cookies and cake started around 10:15am, followed by a sausage sizzle supplied by the club. It went down well and was much appreciated. All

finishing up around 2pm. What a great day!

Next Central Coast Workshop will be on September 2nd and the theme for the day will be 'Healeys on the hoist'. Starting time 9 am bring a plate to share.

All you have to do is turn up. Don't forget, it's on rain hail or shine at 109 Humphreys Road, Kincumber South.

Take care and Happy Healeying. Col and Kerrie Rule.



AHOC Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapters Jindyandy Grain Mill – 9th August 2023

By John Thornton

A beautiful fine and sunny Austin-Healey driving day. We had five Austin-Healeys turn out for the run. And while a lot of members had not heard of "The JindyAndy Mill", all 18 attendees found "The Mill" without any trouble at Pyree, east of Nowra which made a great start for the day.

It was great to see Bruce Wallace and Tess in Bruce's 1959 BT7 Mk 1 and Trevor Cowan and mate Tony in Trevor's BN4. Also, Peter and Elaine Ackhurst in their BT7 Mk2 Roadster. Also included were Gerry and Bernadette South in their 100 and Rex Kilner in his 100 with mate Brenden. I also spoke with Ernst and Joan Jensen, and they would have loved to have attended, but had their bags packed for a cruise.

Other members attending were Chris and Lyn Fitzpatrick, Colin and Delwyn Goldsmith and Fran and I

with our friends, Brian and Jackie Carnegie.

We all wandered out to the Pelican Rocks Café at Greenwell Point for a great seafood lunch.



A car we haven't seen for many a year! The 1959 Mk 1 BT7 of Bruce Wallace.

Illawarra & Southern Highlands Cont'



The 1961 BT7, Mk2 Roadster of Peter Ackhurst I last saw 15 years ago. Peter purchased the car from Brian Small and undertook a complete restoration.



Another car not seen since the early 2000s. The 1957 BN4 Owned and restored by Trevor Cowan.



You can see the ladies got to enjoy the shopping delights of the quaint "Jindyandy Mill". And the boys.....Hey.....boys.....boys, the shops are over here.....yes.....over here!!!!

Mid North Coast Chapter Gathering 19th August 2023

By Phil Lorking

Present:- Chris & Lyndal Hatch, Tony Ash, Glenn & Barbara Robertson, Allan & Di Bryson, Phil & Anthea Lorking.

Tony Ash had been unable to remove the rear splines & brake drums of his new 3000.

The nuts securing these were unable to be loosened with the tools Tony had at home. Phil's toolbox was raided and the offending nuts loosened.

Following that, I showed the group the tools I had made for balancing twin SUs. I found these more accurate than the commercially available pea in the tube products. My two pieces of wire coat hanger bent and inserted into the damper tube of the carb pistons rise up when the car is started. If the ends of the wire do not remain even, they are out of balance and need adjusting. By revving the engine again if

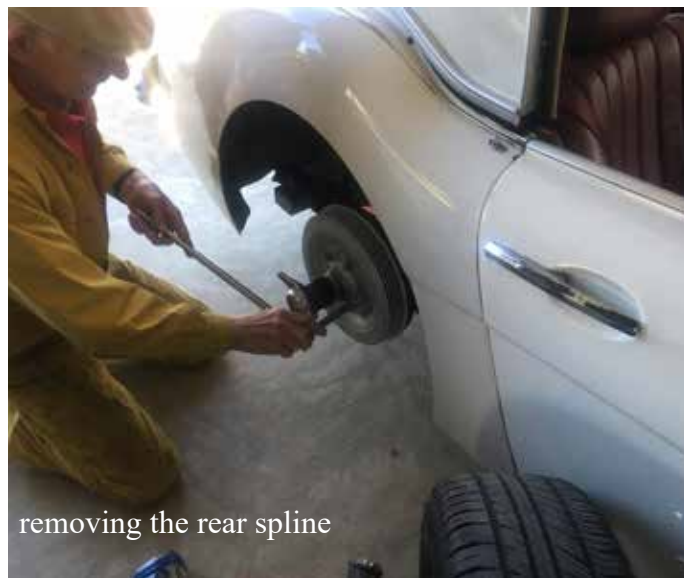
they do not remain even, then you have a sticking piston or uneven spring tension.

We then adjourned to have morning tea/coffee, with the discussion related to a mid-month car run. All agreed especially now the weather is getting a little warmer. The initial run to be to Laurieton Fish Co-op (the best fish & chips), then move onto Dunbogan alongside the river for a picnic. It is proposed that the run will be on Saturday 9th September with meeting at the Co-op at Noon. Emails will be sent out as the date approaches with a better reading of the weather.

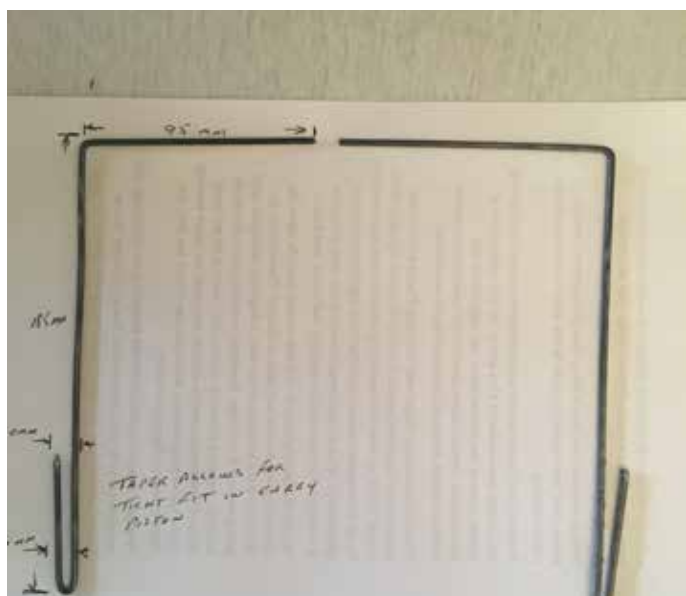
Our next meeting will be 9am Saturday 16th September at Croki. Seems early, but there are five Saturdays in September.



Tony Ash hard at work



removing the rear spline



Brilliant Idea

Spring Cherry Blossom Celebration

By Denis Kasza

The Japanese Garden at the Auburn Botanical Gardens was the scene for the Annual Cherry Blossom Festival, and the Club's run on Sunday August 27th.

We were blessed with a brilliantly bright, sunny and crisp almost spring day. Thousands had turned up for the sold-out Festival and there was plenty to see and do. In addition to the beautifully turned out and maintained gardens, there were plenty of food truck

choices, a sound stage beating out various exotic rhythms and the nearby city council aviary and small zoo to take in.

Present were John and Judy Sherman with their surf club friend, their daughter Kate and her partner and grandchild - BJ9s; Bruce Ewan - white Jaguar E-type; and Susie Doctor and Denis Kasza - BJ9.





Historic Vehicle Registration News

If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.

As the good professor said – “Why is it So?” No matter whether I am trying to understand why something has happened with the Quinn Healey or Austin-Healey, or perhaps why it’s so difficult to follow a simple procedure, the question arises.

I have said this in every Flat Chat Newsletter for three to four years. Please do not send your Conditional Registration documentation by registered post. You will find it below in the second dot point and it’s in bold to make it a little easier to see.

Sending an item by registered post does not speed up

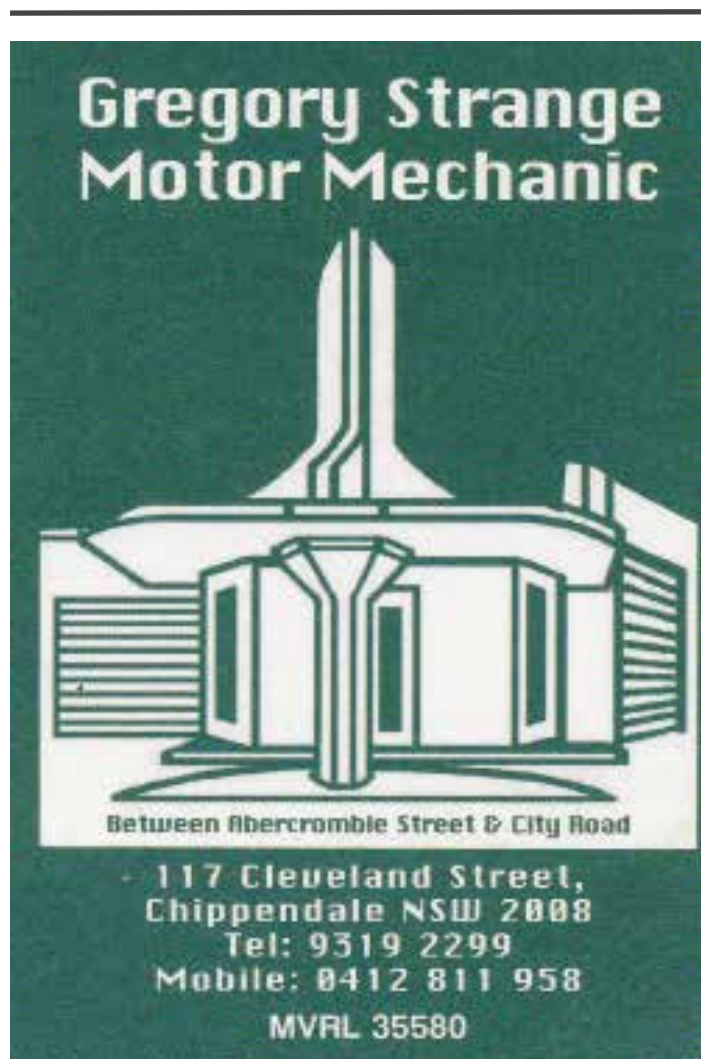
the movement from you to my address, in fact it does quite the opposite. Not only does it pass through additional stages along the way, but the postman doesn’t knock twice. It is not delivered to the receiver’s address (mine!) but is held at the local post office to be picked up.

Three days ago, I received a card telling me that there is a registered item waiting to be picked up at the post office, which is ten minutes away. Sorry I am not about to drop everything, just because someone thinks their documents are important enough for registered post. Three days after receiving the card I picked it up. To add insult to injury, I have been sent a prepaid registered post return envelope. Will I complete the documents with the normal alacrity? Yes! Will I drop everything to take it to the post office? No!

Again, the necessary renewal steps are indicated below.

- Once you have received the renewal papers from Transport for NSW, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 of this Flat Chat for their contact details. Remember all vehicles, including Historic vehicles need to be inspected and passed as roadworthy.
- Complete the left-hand side of the “Historic Vehicle Declaration” and post it to me at my home address (See page 2 of this Flat Chat for my address) along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Please include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate. **Do not post the documents by Registered Post as that just slows down the process as I have to go to the post office to accept a registered postal item.**
- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers.

DON’T FORGET THE STAMPED SELF-ADDRESSED ENVELOPE.



**Gregory Strange
Motor Mechanic**

Between Abercrombie Street & City Road

117 Cleveland Street,
Chippendale NSW 2008
Tel: 9319 2299
Mobile: 0412 811 958
MVRL 35580

AHOC Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapters

"Long Lunch" Taralga



Full Description:

**"A Very Long Drive to have a
Pub Lunch at Taralga Hotel"**

20th September 2023

Nothing better:

Great country driving roads.

A Hearty Pub Lunch with Good Friends

Put this in your diary.

I have 20 places booked for lunch.

So, get in early and book with me.

10:00am Meet at Heatherbrae's Pies Bakery.

Behind the Shell Service Centre on the M1 Sutton Forest.

Sally's Corner Rd Sutton Forest

Have a coffee and cake.

11:00am. Hit the road.

It is about 1:15min drive to Taralga.

We would love to have some of our Central Western Chapter members join us.

Hey! I realised this is closer to you than to some of us!!

Please contact John Thornton on 0419 266 284

Them's the Brakes!

By Allan Whitehouse

Having recently replaced the front brake rotors and pads on my everyday car, I thought I should check those on the BJ7. Looking through the list of work carried out on the Austin-Healey, I found that the last brake overhaul was in 2013, when I fitted new front rotors and pads, and overhauled the callipers. Since then, the car has travelled around 14,000 miles or just over 22,000 kms.

After jacking up the 3000 and removing the front wheels, I took out the pads and measured the lining thickness which was 4-5mm. The workshop manual specifies a disc pad thickness of 10.32mm, so I decided a new set of pads would be advisable. However, what I thought would be a simple pad replacement took a bit longer than expected.

I have my BJ7 details listed in the "My Garage" section of several motor vehicle accessory companies, all of which indicated the correct pad item number to be DB525. After comparing prices (which varied significantly), I placed an order and waited a week for delivery. In the meantime, I thought it prudent to also check the state of the rear brake shoes, so after removing the wheels and drums I compared the current lining thickness of 4.5mm with the 4.76mm listed for new shoes and decided they did not need replacing.

The new set of brake pads duly arrived, and I allocated a couple of hours to carry out what should have been a straight-forward task. The first problem I encountered was that these new pads would not fit the BJ7 callipers. I double-checked the pad item number which each of the accessory companies had confirmed would fit the make, model and year of my Austin-Healey, but still came up with same DB525 unit. Seeking some good technical help, I called Geoff Smith, who explained that the callipers fitted to my car were changed early in the BJ8 (chassis 26705) production phase, so I would need the earlier set of pads.



My next call was to Neville Stirton for advice on his recommended brake parts supplier, which resulted in a trip out to a company in Blacktown. While the staff there were most obliging, after searching through their extensive parts catalogue they were unable to find the exact pad I needed, but they offered to bond a new friction liner to the backing plate of my existing pads. Back home, after further internet searches, I found I could buy a set of ceramic pads on-line at a very reasonable price and with a quick delivery. An additional benefit of these new pads is that they come with an anti-squeal compound bonded to the brake pad backing, so there is no need for anti-squeal shims.

So now, armed with the correct set of disc brake pads and renewed enthusiasm to complete the job, I attempted to insert the new units into the callipers, finding to my dismay, that the rubber dust seals covering the brake pistons were not in the best condition and would be distorted if I tried to force in the new pads. My only option at this stage was to remove the callipers completely and give them a good clean, after which I painted them with high temperature black ceramic paint, necessitating an hour in the kitchen





oven at 200°C to cure (but don't mention this to Jo!). The calliper bores and pistons were still in good condition, but I needed a seal repair kit. I ordered this from The Healey Factory and it was delivered the very next day – a great service!

With all parts now in hand, I reassembled the callipers and fitted them back onto the car. The next step was to bleed the brakes and I found a very useful Youtube video on how to carry out this task single-handedly. The items required for this are a 600ml clear plastic drink bottle (empty), a 60cm length of 6mm ID (9mm OD) clear plastic tubing, a cable tie, a 7/16in and a 3/8in spanner (for the rear and front bleed screws respectively), plus an adequate amount of Dot 3 or Dot 4 brake fluid. Begin by drilling two holes in the bottle cap – a 9mm one for the plastic tubing and a 3mm one to allow for any pressure build-up. Next, push the tubing through the hole in the cap and secure it from underneath with the cable tie. Ensure the tubing reaches the bottom of the bottle when the cap is screwed on. Now pour 100ml of clean brake fluid into the bottle, insert the tube and close the cap. Check that the brake fluid reservoir is topped up, then, starting at the furthestmost

brake (nearside rear for RHD Austin-Healeys), fit the tubing onto the bleed screw, undo the screw approx ¼ turn, and depress the brake pedal slowly to the floor and release. Repeat this pedal operation until the fluid from the bleed screw is clear of air bubbles. Tighten the bleed screw and again top up the reservoir if required. Continue bleeding the remaining brakes in turn from furthest to nearest the reservoir.

Having fitted new disc brake pads, it is important to bed them in properly to prevent any vibration during braking. The process involves performing 8-10 slow-downs from around 50 to 60kph, applying moderate pressure without coming to a complete stop, followed by 2-3 slow-downs from around 60 to 70kph under heavy pressure, again without coming to a complete stop (I used the gears and my handbrake extensively during this procedure). Once completed, allow 15 minutes for the brakes to cool down, but do not apply the brakes during this time or material may be transferred from the pads to the rotor resulting in vibration during braking later on.

Three weeks later – job all done. See, I knew it wouldn't take long!





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PUBLIC ENTRY: 9AM-12:30PM |

DONATION ON ENTRY

There is limited parking onsite for public visitors



**SCAN TO REGISTER
\$100 DONATION
PER CAR ENTRY**



Good Receipts

Thanks to Graham Healey for sending in a copy of this December 1954 receipt for a new Ausin-Healey 100 (BN1/219463).

Didn't know there was an Austin dealership in Hornsby, did you? Looking online I know the exact location to the west of the railway station.

As we know the chassis number, we also know that the car still exists in Victoria and is under restoration. I contacted the owner and I'm pleased to say that he has the original receipt.

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JU 1386
Workshop JU 1464

22nd DECEMBER, 1954

Dr. to **BUTLER BROS. MOTORS PTY. LTD.**
139 PACIFIC HIGHWAY, HORNSBY
Terms: Strictly Net. Settlement within Thirty Days.

Official N.R.M.A. Depot

To Account Rendered		£	s	d
DEC. 22	To Goods: 1 Only NEW AUSTIN - HEALEY "100" ROADSTER	21390	10	
	To Registration & Comp. 3rd Party Insce.	15	14	
		21405	4	
	LESS: DEPOSIT WITH ORDER	975	-	
	To Balance due on delivery	21430	4	
				NET

REG. NO. AFL 344
ENG. NO. 18/219463M
CHAS. NO. BN1/219463
SERIAL NO. 100/109.
YEAR MODEL 1954
COLOUR GREEN
H.P. 18.9
WEIGHT 20 CWT.

I. S. Martin
I seriously submit to have
this to you on the day you took delivery.

E. & O. E. Please add Exchange to Country and Interstate Cheques.

REMEMBER - BUTLER BROS. FOR SERVICE.

10/3/55.

19-11-1970 No. 9

Received from *Colin Rule*

the sum of *Two Hundred* Pounds

FIFTY Shillings *DOLLARS* Pence

being for *AUSTIN HEALEY*

100/1.

\$250.00

Colin Rule

DUTY STAMP

Thank you to Colin Rule for sending in the receipt to the left.

As you can see on 19 November 1970 Colin lashed out \$250 for a 100. He says that the car was really a write off, however the only panel damage on the car was the boot lid. Colin, armed with a set of trade plates ravelled to Kogarah and drove the car home to the Central Coast. A quick coat of black paint, chrome wire wheels and Bob's your uncle. No chassis number unfortunately.

Colin says that no long after he sold his Australian delivered 1964 BJ8 (HBJ8/29376) with 26,000 miles on the clock for \$2,000. I saw it at John Thompson Sports Cars on Parramatta Road, Burwood in April 1972 for \$3,000 and not long after purchased by Mal French. The car is now in Perth.

OCT
28



COOLANGATTA ESTATE LUNCH

Sat Oct 28 10am to 3pm
Visit Treat Factory Berry,
Lunch 12.30 afterwards at
Winery, Shoalhaven Heads.
Northern Members meet
Heathcote Maccas 10am



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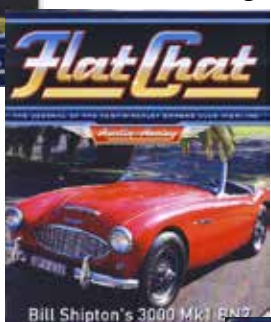
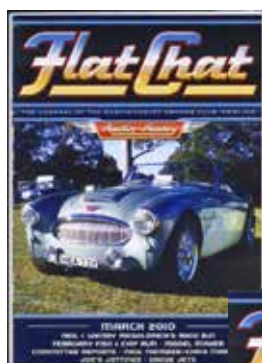
healeyfactory.com.au

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through to September 2023.

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a 1-3GB USB (thumb) drive to me at the below address
along with a stamped self-address envelope.



Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Road
Kurrajong Heights
NSW 2758

You can give me the drive (&
stamp) at a meeting.



A Hundred in Kobe, Japan

by Tomohiro Asada

Couldn't resist the purity
of style - PQ



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Contact: Vince Cessario AHOC Member

info@platinumsash.com.au
13 Waltham Street - Artarmon NSW 2054

Austin and Jensen Cousins

By Patrick Quinn

It's 1953 and the Austin-Healey 100 is slowly becoming available at your local Austin dealership. Compared with other cars on the market it must have been a revelation.

I find it interesting to compare what was available around the time when our cars were new. I may be prejudice, but what was coming from the combined talents of the Donald Healey Motor Company, the Austin Motor Company and Jensen Motors was streets ahead of others manufacturers.

Of course, we know the mechanicals for the 100 including the 2,660cc four cylinder came from the Austin A90 Atlantic, and having driven a few, I do confess to having quite a soft spot for them. Eccentric? Yes that would be a good word to describe them.

With production of the 100 mostly undertaken by Jensen Motors, Austin at Longbridge was able to produce quite a range of cars powered by the smaller 2,199cc version of the engine.

Jensen Motors were busy as well, and not just with the contract for the 100. In October 1953 Jensen released the 541, my favourite sports coupe of the 1950s.

Fitted with the six-cylinder version of the 100 engine at 3,995cc and other Austin mechanicals from the Sheerline, plus a four-speed gearbox and Laycock de Normanville overdrive, the 541 had a top speed of 109mph. It was also fitted with fibreglass bodywork, except for the doors that were in aluminium. The 1956 model was also the first British four-seater with disc brakes all round.



Cousins cont'



Austin A70



A70 Utility

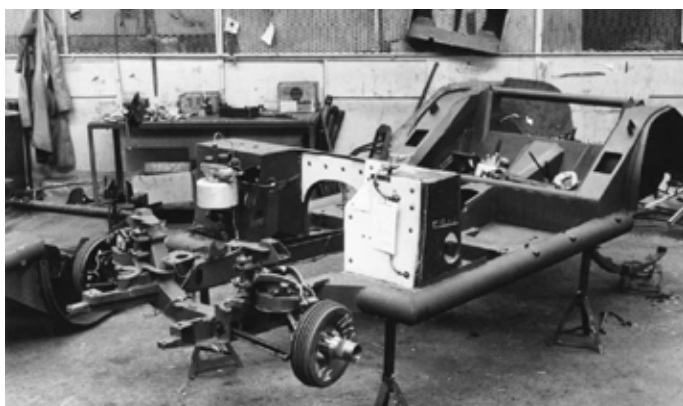


A70 Countryman



A70 based van

Meanwhile at Jensen Motors

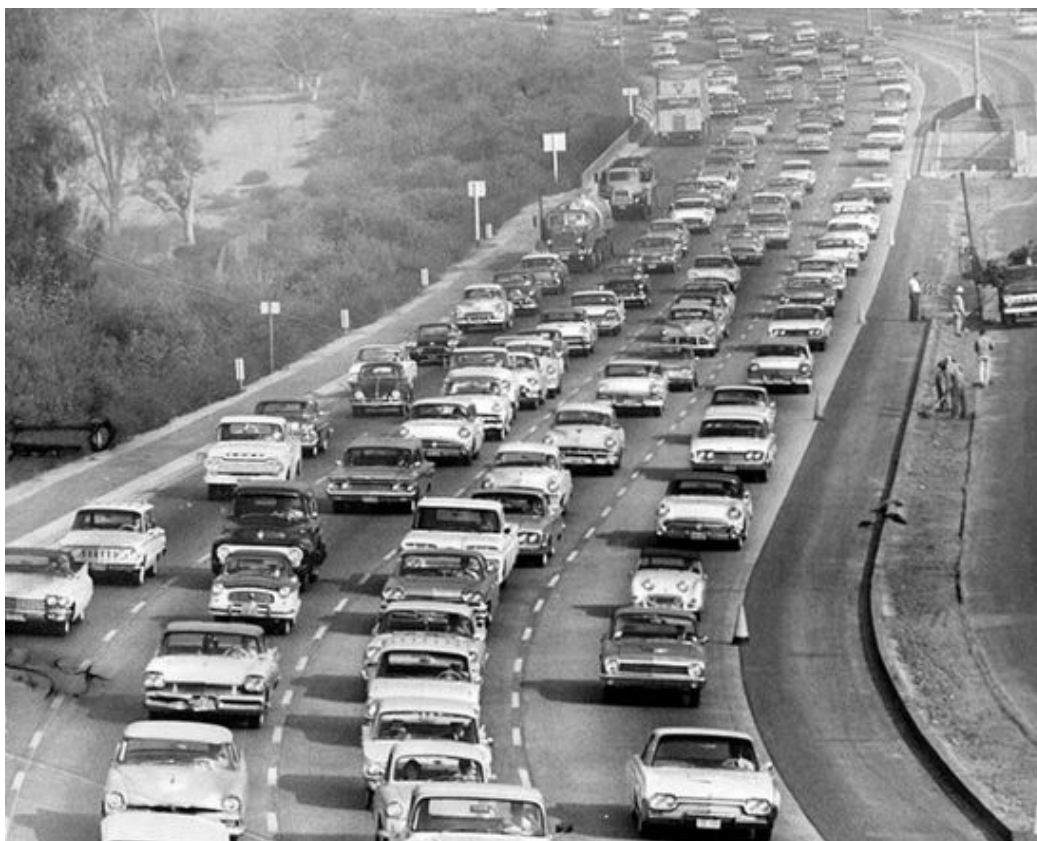


Your editor enjoying a Jensen 541 in Sydney.



What Ford was offering at the same time!!!

Your Last Page



Spot the Austin-Healey

Los Angeles 1961

Actually this one is pretty easy.



Works Rally 3000 URX 727 in 1960 driven by Pat Moss.



Looks like it's been dropped from a great height. Sad!



Six-Cylinder Record Breaker in the wind tunnel.

Monthly Meetings - Zoom ID 980 9019 7648 Passcode 336164

**Normally we meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club
Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm**